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CFETP 21AX
PARTS I AND II
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21AX CFETP



AIRCRAFT MAINTENANCE OFFICER CAREER FIELD EDUCATION AND TRAINING PLAN

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PART I

Preface

1. The development of aircraft maintenance officers is executed through education, training, and experience and informed by Tactics, Techniques and Procedures (TTPs). As the character of warfare continues to evolve, aircraft maintainers must contend with significant fiscal constraints, outdated equipment, manning shortfalls, and an increasingly uncertain geopolitical atmosphere. Despite a changing global environment, Maintainers will continue to develop and lead Airmen to fight our nation's wars. This plan was created IAW DAFMAN 36-2689 para 3.2 with revisions following the process found in Attachment A4.4, and Table A4.1.

2. Aircraft maintenance officers are Airmen first and maintainers/logisticians always. As such, they must embody the Air Force core values, and the enterprise must develop maintenance officers who exemplify the qualities and capabilities necessary to lead in the multi-domain fight. To help maintenance officers gain the skills and competencies needed to become agile and innovative leaders, this Career Field Education and Training Plan (CFETP) utilizes a competency-based force development model to ensure maintenance officers are ready to lead our Airmen and are capable of sustaining the Air Force's power projection platforms. All officers should use the 21A Occupational Competency Model (OCM), along with their supervisors, mentors, and commanders to evaluate proficiency throughout their careers and guide force development.

Section A – CFETP Overview, Uses and Responsibilities

1. **The Career Field Education and Training Plan.** The CFETP consists of two parts, including links, which are used to plan, manage, and shape education and training within the 21A career field.

1.1. **Part I Overview.** Part I is divided into four sections. Section A outlines what the CFETP is, how it should be used, and responsibilities. Section B provides a career field description. Section C introduces the concept of Competency Based Learning, explains the 21A Occupational Competency Model and the proficiency levels desired through different stages in each officer's career. Section D outlines maintenance officer career progression and the earning and wearing of the occupational badges.

1.2. **Part II Overview.** Part II consists of four sections. Part A provides information on skill certification and maintenance badge heraldry. Part B discusses AFLOS, TTPs and introduces the 21A Course Matrix that breaks out the courses associated with the competencies and level of proficiency. It also provides a quick listing of courses by rank and position to complement the 21A Course Matrix. Section C discusses officer professional development, developmental education, graduate education, and certifications. Section D provides information on supervising maintenance officers, to include the commander's involvement, competency assessment and documentation, officer evaluation and promotion systems, and awards. Section E provides an acronym list for reference.

2. **Using the CFETP.** The CFETP is a tool to provide guidance for the 21A career field to ensure continuity of training and competency throughout an officers' career. The CFETP provides a starting point for each officer to understand the competencies expected of them as they progress through their career, and a roadmap with tools they can use to achieve their highest potential. *It is incumbent upon the individual to own their career progression and seek feedback.*

2.1. **Individual:** Individuals will actively seek out opportunities to learn, develop, and refine core competencies throughout their career. The challenge of becoming a better aircraft maintenance officer does not end with the award of the maintenance badge but is a career long pursuit to advance from basic through expert proficiency in the core competencies.

2.2. **Supervisor/Director of Operations:** Supervisors and Director of Operations (or equivalent) will ensure officers in training understand the fundamentals of each CFETP competency and guide them through the progression of their training and education. Recommend reviewing training status with trainees during formal feedback intervals (initial, midterm, annual) with frequent informal feedback on their progress and recommendations for improvement.

2.3. **Squadron Commander:** Squadron Commanders, or equivalent, are responsible for ensuring their assigned officers understand the purpose and intent of the occupational competency training model. Through deliberate mentorship and feedback, both formal and informal, they will ensure the officers in their squadron are progressing in the occupational competencies. Commanders will ensure training is properly documented in TBA 2.0. Squadron Commanders (or next higher authority) should IAW DAFI 36-2650 para 2.1 certify officer progression by signing the DAF Form 2096 and awarding the basic and senior certifications.

2.4. **Group Commander:** Group Commanders, or equivalent, will IAW DAFI 36-2650 establish a group training program to ensure the progression of all officers from O-1 through O-6. They are responsible for officer development across the group. Notify MAJCOMs of formal training shortfalls to ensure timely correction and redirection of formal training emphasis. Group Commanders (or next higher authority) will certify officer progression by signing the DAF Form 2096 and awarding the master certification.

3. **Coordination and Approval.** The CFETP is approved and maintained by the Air Force Aircraft Maintenance Career Field Manager (CFM) in accordance with DAFI 36-2689, "Training Program." Coordinate changes through respective MAJCOM Development Team (DT) Chair to the Aircraft Maintenance Career Field Manager (CFM), HQ USAF/A4LM.

Section B – Career Field Description

1. **The Aircraft Maintenance Officer Career Field.** The Aircraft Maintenance specialty (AFSC 21AX), as defined by the Air Force Officer Classification Directory, leads, trains, and equips personnel supporting aerospace equipment sustainment and operations. Manages maintenance and modification of aircraft and associated equipment. Administers aircraft maintenance programs and resources. Directs aircraft maintenance production, staff activity, and related material programs. Assess unit capability and advises senior leadership.

2. For current AFSC description and information on officer professional development, access the Department of the Air Force Officer Classification Directory MyFSS page. The DAFOCD takes precedence when information differs from this CFETP.

Section C – Competency Model and Proficiency Levels

1. **Competency Based Learning.** The Air Force defines competency as an observable, measurable pattern of behaviors, knowledge, skills, abilities and other characteristics needed to perform successfully on the job. Competency based learning is focused on the learner and includes multiple methods of training and self-paced activities. This model puts the responsibility on the learner to promote individual ownership of their education.

1.1. This method enables aircraft maintenance officers to grow and develop through on-the-job training, formal courses, online training, certifications, and other learning opportunities. Officers must be active in their quest to master each competency and be able to demonstrate individual mastery of each competency, through each proficiency level. Each officer joins the community with different skills and backgrounds. The segregated and self-paced nature of competency-based learning allows each person to build on those skills and adapt beyond the on-the-job training to augment and enhance each competency with their preferred learning style.

1.2. Competencies are not meant to be initial skills acquisition, but rather a career long pursuit of becoming better aircraft maintenance officers in each of our competencies. There is no one path to success; therefore, we utilize occupational competencies to guide individual development.

1.3. Competencies should not be confused with skills. A skill is the ability to do something, while a competency may require the use of multiple skills together. A competency is the ability to apply, transfer and combine knowledge, skills, and abilities in different situations and environments to carry out required activities at the desired quality level.

1.4. For competency-based learning to be effective, each learner must demonstrate each competency. This can be evaluated through different methods. While observation and interaction are preferred, there may be other methods that are more effective for the supervisor/trainer which can be developed. Because competencies are developed from the traits of successful maintainers, mastering each one allows the career field to adjust with changing organizational structures and presentation of forces.

1.5. The competency model below is not intended to be utilized as a task-based checklist. However, MAJCOMs, maintenance groups (or equivalent), and/or squadrons are encouraged to establish local officer training requirements that address technical skills specific to the local mission and/or airframe(s), which may be derived from task lists found in legacy training models. (See Section D, para 1.4)

2. **21A Occupational Competency Model.** DAFPD 36-26, "Total Force Development and Management," states occupational competencies are required of all Airmen within a specific workforce category. They describe technical/functional skills, knowledge, abilities, behaviors, and other characteristics needed to perform the mission successfully**.**

2.1. To define the competencies valued by the Aircraft Maintenance career field, a study was conducted with HQ AETC/A3AJ and subject matter experts from each MAJCOM to develop the 21A Occupational Competency Model (OCM). The model was validated through field surveys of O-1s through O-5s, with final validation from the career field O-6s. These competencies then shaped the curriculum for initial technical training at the Air Force Logistics Officer School (AFLOS) and is the basis for our Career Field Education and Training Plan (CFETP). More information can be found in AFH 36-2647, "Competency Modeling."

2.2. Five competencies define the 21A career field. Each competency is further broken down into sub-competencies (see 21A OCM below) that refine the skills required for an aircraft maintenance officer. While each commander and supervisor may have their own process for evaluating and determining that the officers under them have achieved the desired level of expertise in each competency, observable behaviors for each sub-competency at each level of proficiency have been provided in the 21A Course Matrix and as a separated document titled 21A OCM Rubric, both located on the 21A MyFSS page.

21A Occupational Competency Model (OCM)		
Competency	**Sub-Competency**	**Sub-Competency Description**
Leadership	Leading People	Influencing personnel to meet or exceed mission requirements
	Process Mgmt	Oversight and integration of process across functions and organizations to execute mission requirements
	Organizational Improvement	Implementing change resulting in increased effectiveness and resource utilization
	Training	Preparing and posturing Airmen to meet the current and future AF mission parameters
Communication	Communication	Clear and effective at articulating, presenting, and promoting ideas/challenges/issues to a broad audience
Institutional Structural Organization	Institutional Structural Organization	Advocating and collaborating across the defense sector (DOD/Total Force/Joint) to achieve institutional goals
Mission Execution	Mission Generation	Preparing for and executing the unit's primary mission
	Safety and Risk Mgmt	Appropriately assessing and managing operational risks
	Combat Support/Combat Service Support	Possessing a level of influence to ensure sufficient support and management in combat operations
	Scheduling	Organizing time-base activities to achieve the unit's mission
	Planning	Developing and establishing standards and expectations for future mission success
	Quality Assurance	Driving a productive quality assessment system to enhance readiness and reliability
	Data Analysis	Proper utilization of data to improve operations and decision making
Resource Management	Programs	Organizational functions that provide structure, control, and guidance
	Life Cycle Mgmt	Identifying shortfalls and leveraging resources (internal/external) to meet and exceed weapon
	Equipment Mgmt	Effective oversight of the unit's physical assets
	Budget	Executing oversight of unit's budget and resourcing priorities in a manner that drives cost effective mission execution

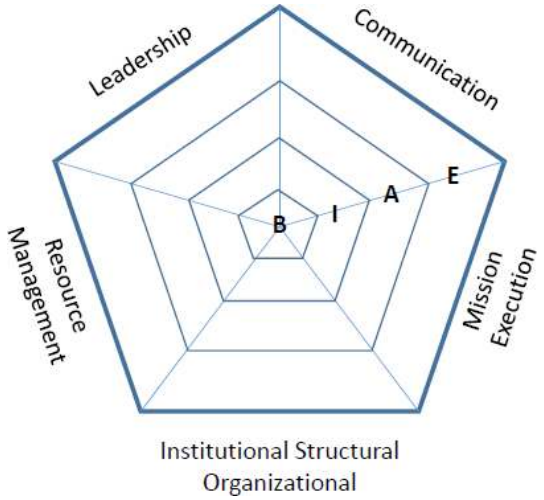
2.3. **Competency Proficiency Levels.** 21A subject matter experts defined the sub-competencies and determined the behaviors for the four proficiency levels: Basic, Intermediate, Advanced, and Expert. The observable behaviors for each competency/sub-competency can be found in the 21A Course Matrix and in the 21A OCM Rubric on the 21A MyFSS page. The rank and timelines for each level are estimated windows, not prescriptive.

Basic – Defined by showing proficiency within their assigned area of responsibility. Their reach of influence is at the individual and the flight or unit level. Able to operate within the defined bounds of their workplace and demonstrate sustained application of competency over time. Second/First Lieutenants with 0 to 4 years' time in maintenance.

Intermediate – Defined by increased influence at the squadron and group or equivalent levels. Able to operate outside of the bounds of their immediate work center with cross functional teams to integrate their area of concern with the larger mission. Demonstrate sustained application of competency over time and in a variety of situations to include those without established procedures. Captains with 4 to 7 years' time in maintenance.

Advanced – Defined by influence at the group and wing or equivalent levels. Able to operate without established procedures and integrate operations with organizational strategies. Demonstrate sustained application of competencies over time in complex situations. Majors with over 10 years' time in maintenance.

Expert – Defined by influence at Major Command and Headquarters Air Force levels. Able to operate in environments that require development of innovative procedures. Formulates strategy for execution at MAJCOM and HAF levels. Lieutenant Colonels and Colonels.



Section D – Career Progression

1. **Maintenance Officer Career Progression.** Department of the Air Force Instruction 21-101, "Aircraft and Equipment Maintenance Management" outlines and defines the roles and responsibilities assigned to each flight and position within a typical maintenance group. The current version of DAFI 21-101 can be found on the Air Force E-Publishing website.

1.1. **Career Development Brief (CDB).** Generated by our functional community leaders and coordinated with each MAJCOM, the CDB provides the most current information for officer career development and planning. It serves as a reference to educate mentors, hiring authorities, and promotion boards about the career field and what it values. It includes typical career milestones, developmental guidance, and career broadening expectations. The current CDB can be found on the 21A – Aircraft Maintenance Officer page on MyFSS.

1.2. **Prior to Major.** 21As are expected to develop Basic-level proficiency, achieve at least Intermediate-level proficiency, and begin progress toward Advanced-level proficiency in the 21A competencies. They must expand upon their basic leadership and professional skills while increasing their tactical competence over the course of 2-3 wing-level assignments as e.g., Flight Commander, Assistant AMU OIC, AMU OIC, and Director of Operations to become a fully qualified 21A3. They are expected to develop and exhibit sound leadership, judgement, critical thinking, conflict management, and analytical skills through increasingly complex spans of control and responsibility. 21A company grade officers (CGOs) will often lead large organizations of upwards of 200-400 personnel.

1.3. **Prior to Lieutenant Colonel.** 21As are expected to achieve at least Advanced Level of proficiency in the 21A competencies prior to Lieutenant Colonel. They must demonstrate strong leadership, operational and strategic competence, strong planning and communication skills, and show sustained superior performance as Director of Operations (or equivalent) and Squadron Commanders.

1.4. **Prior to Colonel.** 21As are expected to progress from Advanced Level toward Expert Level of proficiency in the 21A competencies prior to Lieutenant Colonel. They must effectively lead organizations and think strategically, while applying significant tactical depth, as Squadron Commanders and Deputy Group Commanders or equivalent, as well as in Wing Staff, sustainment enterprise, and headquarters roles (i.e. Air Logistics Complex, NAF, MAJCOM, and Air Staff). Squadron command at least once at the FGO level is typical and many will command multiple times. Prior to O-6, 21As should have completed at least one short tour or deployment. Career progression should enable officers to become strong Maintenance Group Commanders, or equivalent, who will also produce results at the wing, MAJCOM, and Air Force level.

1.5. **Career Broadening Expectations.** Selective programs for 21As include the Advanced Maintenance and Munitions Operations School (AMMOS), Logistics Career Broadening Program (LCBP), Base Level Broadening Program (BLBP), Education with Industry (EWI), Acquisition and Logistics Experience Exchange Tour (ALEET), Operations Research Analyst and Logistics Experience Exchange Tour (OLEET), and AFIT advanced academic degree programs. Formal instructor or recruiting special duty are valued assignments for personal development and enterprise perspective – usually after four commissioned years of service. While these programs are valuable in expanding breadth and depth of experience for all maintenance officers, these are not substitutes for gaining the required aircraft maintenance experience necessary to develop officers into well rounded commanders. Additionally, while each opportunity provides a different broadening experience, officers are not encouraged to seek multiple broadening opportunities.

PART II

Section A – Skill Certification and Badge Heraldry

1. **21AX Skill Certification:**

1.1. **Basic Certification.** The Department of the Air Force Officer Classification Directory (DAFOCD) requires a minimum of 24 months assigned to a 21A position for basic upgrade to 21A3. Additionally, the following criteria is required:

- Achievement of Basic Level of proficiency in the 21A competencies
- Complete Aircraft Maintenance Officer Course or equivalent.
  Note: Maintenance occupational badge is awarded upon completion of AMOC.

1.2. **Senior Certification.** Officers become eligible for Senior Certification upgrade within approximately 8 years of completed 21A experience, at the discretion of the Squadron Commander, provided the following criteria is accomplished:

- Achievement of Intermediate Level of proficiency in the 21A competencies
- Complete Maintenance Officer Intermediate Course (MOIC) or Combat Mission Generation Course (CMGC) at AMMOS
  - Officers may attend both courses, but only one is required prior to upgrade
- Accomplishment of key 21A positions:
  - Successful completion of 24-36 months as an Flt/CC and/or AMU OIC or equivalent, Note: Some Flight Commander positions of complex flights may satisfy this requirement, contingent on MXG/CC approval
  - Successful completion of at least 12 months as a maintenance DO or equivalent

1.3. **Master Certification.** Officers become eligible for the Master Certification within 12 years of coded 21A experience, at the discretion of the Group Commander or equivalent, provided the following criteria is accomplished:

- Achievement of Advanced Level of proficiency in the 21A competencies
- Successful completion of a squadron command tour (note: waiver option for ARC at AFRC and NGB 21A CFM level)

1.4. **Prior-Enlisted Maintenance Officers**. In accordance with DAFI 36-2903, "Dress and Appearance," prior-enlisted officers who held senior/master maintenance badges may continue to wear awarded badges. However, these officers are required to meet all CFETP training requirements for maintenance officer career progression.

2. **Maintenance Badge Heraldry.** The design of the falcon is a replica of the maintenance falcon located at the National Cathedral in Washington D.C. The falcon symbolizes the airborne strength of the Air Force made possible by maintainers. In its talons, the falcon is holding a bomb and a generic 21st century aircraft. They are crossed to show the interrelationship of the career fields. The aircraft is symbolic of all aircraft maintained by the personnel who wear the badge. The bomb symbolizes the primary mission of the Air Force maintainer to make sure they put the bombs on target. The field is without obstruction and depicts a free sky. The olive wreath surrounding the badge symbolizes the peace which we defend through professional maintenance.



2.1. Basic Badge. Awarded upon successful entry into the career field at the completion of the Aircraft Maintenance Officer Course (AMOC)



2.2. Senior Badge. Adds a star to the top of the badge (see Senior Certification eligibility criteria in Part II, Section A)



2.3. Master Badge. Indicates the final step in the occupational series and adds a wreath around the star (see Master Certification eligibility criteria in Part II, Section A)

Section B – Training and Education Courses for Development

1. **Air Force Logistics Officer School (AFLOS).** AFLOS at Sheppard AFB, Texas provides competency-based, student-centered training and education for officers. The Aircraft Maintenance Officer Course (AMOC) is the basic maintenance badge awarding course and develops competencies at the basic level. The Maintenance Officer Intermediate Course (MOIC) develops competencies at the intermediate level. MOIC provides training targeted at preparing officers for AMU OIC and recommends sending 1st Lieutenants with three years commissioned time in service. Current information on the Logistics Officer Orientation Program (LOOP) prerequisite to AMOC, additional courses, and AFLOS contact info can be found on the AFLOS MyFSS page.

1.1. **AMOC Bridge Course.** This 19-day academic course familiarizes students that already possess a basic level officer competency with technical fundamentals of a maintenance organization. Student performance is evaluated via knowledge-based measurements. AMOC Bridge is no longer a condensed version of AMOC. Thus, prior enlisted maintenance experience does not guarantee bridge course attendance. Items to be considered for bridge course attendance include whether the officer has been assessed at a "Basic" level across the OCM rubric. Additional information to consider includes: Earning a 7-level within an enlisted maintenance AFSC, Senior Noncommissioned Officer and/or Field Grade Officer rank, and flightline experience. The authority to recommend the bridge course for prior enlisted, retrained, or broadening officers is the MXG/CC or equivalent, with final approval determined by the 21A CFM.

2. **Tactics Techniques and Procedures (TTP).** The TTPs are a great source for lessons learned, training materials, successful and unsuccessful practices, topics for further exploration, and a good place to look for guidance when faced with new situations or jobs. This can help with developing proficiency in many different competencies. The latest version of the Aircraft Maintenance TTPs can be found on the Air Force Combat Support TTP Repository website, in the AFTTP Library.

3. **21A Course Matrix.** The 21A Course Matrix is a user-friendly matrix of courses available to all 21As from a variety of sources to include e.g., AFIT, DAU, AETC. The Course Matrix is organized by proficiency level and competencies. Each of the courses available is broken down and evaluated for applicability to each core competency and sub-competency and to what level of proficiency it best complements. Additionally, the courses are weighted by the number of competencies they address and indicate whether they contribute to the Professional Maintenance Certification Program (PMxCP). *While no single course will provide an officer with a full measure of comprehension in a core competency, each class is able to enhance development. Combined with supervisory feedback, officers should identify which competencies they need to develop and choose courses that will aid in personal development.* The 21A Course Matrix is located on the 21A MyFSS page.

4. **Course Quick Reference.** The below quick listing identifies courses at each level of expertise aligned with the occupational competencies. This is not all encompassing but does provide a roadmap of the courses to compliment the 21A Course Matrix and unit training plans.

Recommended Courses for Lieutenants 0-4 Years as 21A In line with BASIC competencies		
Course #	**Course Name**	**Source**
*ACQ 1010	Fundamentals of Systems Acquisition Management	WARU
*CLE 015	Continuous Process Improvement Familiarization	WARU
WDAS 101	Intro to Data Analytics	AFIT
*WFPM 101	Fundamentals of Project Management	AFIT
*WLOG 099	Fundamentals of Logistics	AFIT
*WLOG 051	Intro to Supply Chain Management	AFIT
WLOG 199	Intro to Logistics AF	AFIT
WKTOC 101	Theory of Constraints TOC 101	AFIT
WKLDR 101	Generational Communication in Logistics	AFIT
** Denotes course towards PMxCP certification. Refer to 21A Course Matrix on the 21A MyFSS page for additional information.*		

Recommended Courses for Captain through Major 5-10 Years as 21A In line with INTERMEDIATE competencies		
Course #	**Course Name**	**Source**
W21X 302	Budget Basics for Logisticians	AFIT
W21X 310	AF Weapons System Sustainment	AFIT
W21X 311	Depot Maintenance Operations	AFIT
W21X 324	Deployment Planning	AFIT
WDAS 201	Fundamentals of Data Analytics	AFIT
WIPM 301	Intermediate Project Management Skills Course	AFIT
*WLOG 209	Concepts of Industrial Maintenance Management	AFIT
WLOG 299	Combat Logistics	AFIT
WLDR 108	Dynamic Teaming	AFIT
WKTOC 201	Theory of Constraints TOC 201	AFIT
** Denotes course towards PMxCP certification. Refer to 21A Course Matrix on the 21A MyFSS page for additional information.*		

Recommended Courses for Lt Col Through Colonel 14+ Years as 21A In line with ADVANCED and EXPERT core competencies		
Course #	**Course Name**	**Source**
W21X 301	Staff Level Logistics Planning	AFIT
WLOG 238	Critical Chain Project Management Foundational Concepts	AFIT
WLOG 262	Applied Maintenance and Logistics Management Concepts	AFIT
WLOG 309	Applied Concepts of Industrial Operations Management	AFIT
WLOG 390	Organizational Leadership in Five Lessons	AFIT
WLOG 399	Strategic Logistics Management	AFIT
WLOG 420	Enterprise Logistics Course	AFIT
JLC	Joint Logistics Course	Army Logistics Univ

Recommended Courses Prior to Squadron Command 10+ Years as 21A		
Course #	**Course Name**	**Source**
Recommended	21X Squadron Command Seminar	HAF A4LM
Mandatory	AFPC Pre-Command Course	AFPC
Mandatory	MAJCOM Squadron Command Orientation	MAJCOM
Mandatory	Leader Development Course (LDC) for Squadron Command	Air University
LOG 390	Achieving Organizational Alignment	AFIT

Recommended Courses Prior to Deputy Group Command 15+ Years as 21A		
Course #	**Course Name**	**Source**
GSCEDP	Global Supply Chain Executive Development Program (UT)	HAF A4LM
WLOG 420	Enterprise Logistics Course	AFIT
WLDR 106	Understanding Generations	AFIT
WLDR 108	Dynamic Teaming	AFIT
WLDR 390	Organizational Leadership in Five Lessons	AFIT
WKDAS 672	Data Analytics Tools and Techniques	AFIT
WKLDR 101	Generational Communication in Logistics	AFIT
WKTOC 201	Theory of Constraints TOC 201	AFIT

Section C – Professional Development and Certifications

1. **Officer Professional Development (OPD).** OPD continues throughout our careers and consists of developmental education, graduate education, occupational continuing education, and professional certificates, as well as less formal engagement with supervisors and mentors. Officers have ultimate responsibility for their development and education; aggressively pursuing excellence requires a lifelong dedication towards developing our skillsets and knowledge, which, when coupled with experience, yields ever increasing performance and results.

1.1. **Avolve.** The Avolve Aircraft Maintenance Hub is a collaborative learning environment where you can find and share training and development documents and videos. Avolve uses algorithms like YouTube and Netflix to make it easy to connect, discover, and contribute. It also has a Google Search like function that will search across other hubs to find the most relevant content. The site can be accessed at the following Avolve link.

2. **Developmental Education (DE).** DE is categorized into Primary (PDE), Intermediate (IDE), and Senior Developmental Education (SDE); it is collectively referred to as Professional Military Education (PME).

2.1. IDE and SDE in-residence are highly selective programs; therefore, if not selected to attend DE in-residence, officers need to complete the appropriate level of DE by Distance Learning for promotion consideration. Talk with your supervisor or commander about the current IDE and SDE selection process.

2.2. DE should be completed at the officer's earliest opportunity to further their doctrinal development and remain competitive for future leadership opportunities.

2.4. For more information on DE, go to MyFSS, Officer Force Development Home Page, Officer Developmental Education and Special Programs page.

3. **Graduate Education.** Each year, there are a number of opportunities for officers to gain Air Force-sponsored master's degrees, and in limited cases, doctorate-level degrees. A portion of these degrees require follow-on commitments for the officer to fill, such as a faculty position at AFIT, USAFA or with the Defense Logistics Agency (DLA).

3.1. Graduate Education, whether obtained via an AF-sponsored program or not, is instrumental to increasing the knowledge base that can help an officer improve their performance and contributions to their organizations and the enterprise. Although requirements for graduate education have changed throughout the years, it should still be viewed as a front-loaded investment in yourself and can be both explicitly and implicitly beneficial. Not only does it increase knowledge in the specified academic area but also enhances communication and critical thinking skills.

3.2. More information on advanced academic degree (AAD) opportunities, go to MyFSS, Officer Force Development Home Page, Officer Developmental Education and Special Programs page.

4. **Occupational Continuing Education (OCE).** OCE enhances technical and managerial skills by keeping us current in our jobs and the maintenance and logistics industry.

4.1. OCE can be obtained by attending courses at AFIT's School of Systems and Logistics, Defense Acquisition University (DAU), colleges or universities, and commercial training organizations. Professional organizations in the local area may also have information on the OCE courses that are available commercially.

4.2. For a list of available OCE courses, refer to the 21A Course Matrix on the 21A MyFSS page. For additional course information, visit the AFIT website and DAU website.

5. **Professional Licensure and Credentialing.** Professional licensure and certification are options available to maintenance officers. It is not mandatory for maintenance officers to be licensed or certified, but it may enhance an officer's overall professional development and may provide the officer with additional opportunities throughout his/her career, both in and out of the military.

5.1. When balancing the desire for licensure or certification, maintenance officers should ensure it is not at the detriment of appropriate Developmental Education or job performance, as failure to meet standards in those areas may hinder chances of promotion (professional certification may not be considered by promotion boards). Furthermore, it enhances rather than replaces, formal development outlined in this CFETP.

5.2. Various certifications and licenses exist, including the Air Force Professional Maintenance Certification Program (PMxCP), Life Cycle Logistics Certification (LCL), Airframe and Powerplant (A&P) License, Continuous Process Improvement Green Belt, Program Management Professional (PMP), etc. Information on the PMxCP and LCL certifications can be found on the Air Force Logistics Professional Development Program website.

5.3. Note that some professional certifications require annual or biannual continuing education credits or testing to maintain currency. Professional Continuing Education courses, including those offered by AFIT and DAU, may help fulfill some of these continuing education requirements. Additionally, some certifications require a specific amount of time in certain positions (ex. acquisition coded billets) in addition to the course requirements.

Section D – Supervising Maintenance Officers

1. **Commander's Involvement.** Commanders and Directors have the best insight into a particular officer's talents, strengths, limitations, and Professional Development needs. Commanders and Directors *must* be involved in the *deliberate* development, education, and training of *their* maintenance officers. Commanders/Directors foster a commitment to professional excellence by ensuring officers pursue completion of the requirements along the institutional and occupational continuums of learning outlined within this plan. They also lead their officers to future excellence via continual, clear, unambiguous, in-person, holistic feedback.

1.1. Commander/Director responsibilities are divided into three focuses:

Focus I: General Airmanship development

Focus II: General occupational development

Focus III: Specific assignment, duty and vector guidance

1.2. Refer to AFI 1-2, "Commander's Responsibilities" for more discussion on the enterprise's expectations for Squadron Commanders in developing leaders.

1.3. Commanders are responsible for ensuring proper documentation of officer training via TBA 2.0. Supervisors/commanders should assess their officers using the observable behaviors listed in the 21A OCM Rubric on the 21A MyFSS page and sign them off at the appropriate proficiency level. All officers upgraded to 21A3 prior to 1 December 2021, are considered "grandfathered" and can be signed off on all competencies at the basic level. It is highly encouraged to use journal entries to communicate with subordinates regarding their strengths, areas for improvement, and recommendations. Journal entries provide continuity of training as officers move to other units and bases.

1.4. While TBA 2.0 is the system of record for training documentation, units are encouraged to develop local training plans that effectively implement and track officer training progress. Training plan examples can be found on the 21A MyFSS page under Training Plan Examples. Units may, but are not limited to, use of the provided examples in developing their local plans.

1.5. Commanders/Directors can find resources to aid in mentoring maintenance officers at the 21A MyFSS page, as well as through official Facebook groups like the "HAF A4L 21X Officer Force Development" and "USAF Maintenance Officer Forum."

1.6. Commanders/Directors should rotate officers through positions within their organization to develop the officer's overall maintenance expertise in a manner that best suits their development and the organization's needs.

2. **Officer Evaluation System (OES).** AFI 36-2406 discusses the Officer Evaluation System (OES). This instruction includes information on the objective of the program, documenting job performance as well as dealing with Airman Comprehensive Assessments (ACAs), Officer Performance Briefs (OPBs), and Promotion Recommendation Forms (PRFs).

2.1. 21A Duty Title standardization:

a. Do not use "Aircraft Maintenance Officer" / "Maintenance Officer" as a duty title (be specific); this is an AFSC, not a duty title.
b. Do not over abbreviate. Use the entirety of the 31-character limit MilPDS offers (includes spacing).
c. Spell out as much as possible IAW the standards below.
d. Do not misspell words. Follow-up with the local MPF to correct records if any are identified (while it may be close, misspellings and abbreviations do not allow for accurate record pulls or career field analysis) and indicate a lack of interest by the officer and their chain of command.
e. Duty titles are being consolidated to align with non-maintenance and logistics AFSCs.
f. Do not use commas in the duty title.
g. Only the most used duty titles are listed below.
h. Duty title standardization listing:

SQUADRON LEVEL	
COMMANDER	
DIRECTOR OF OPERATIONS	
OIC (Responsibility)	
OIC AIRCRAFT MAINTENANCE UNIT	OIC SORTIE GENERATION
OIC SORTIE SUPPORT	
ASST OIC (Responsibility)	
ASST OIC AIRCRAFT MAINTENANCE UNIT	
FLT CC (Responsibility)	
FLT CC ACCESSORIES	FLT CC LOW OBSERVABLES
FLT CC AEROSPACE GROUND EQUIP	FLT CC MAINTENANCE
FLT CC ARMAMENT	FLT CC MAINTENANCE TRAINING
FLT CC AVIONICS	FLT CC PROPULSION
FLT CC FABRICATION	

GROUP LEVEL	
GROUP COMMANDER	
DEPUTY GROUP COMMANDER	
OIC QUALITY ASSURANCE	OIC MAINTENANCE OPERATIONS
OIC WEAPONS & TACTICS	

EXECUTIVE OFFICER (LEVEL)	
EXECUTIVE OFFICER WING	EXECUTIVE OFFICER GROUP

STAFF LEVEL
DIRECTOR (Responsibility)
DEP DIRECTOR (Responsibility)
CHIEF (Responsibility) SECTION/BRANCH/DIVISION
DEP CHIEF (Responsibility) SECTION/BRANCH/DIVISION
ACTION OFFICER (Responsibility)
MAJCOM/COMBATANT COMMAND (Responsibility)

SPECIAL PROGRAMS	
OLEET RESEARCH ANALYST (Responsibility)	PHX MOBILITY INTERN (Responsibility)
PHX TORCH INTERN (Responsibility)	INSTRUCTOR (Insert School House)
ALEET PRGM MGR (Responsibility)	EWI FELLOW (Insert Company)
LOG CAREER BROADENING OFFICER	AFIT MASTERS STUDENT
BASE-LEVEL BROADENING OFFICER	AFIT PHD STUDENT

IDE/SDE	
STUDENT (IDE Program)	
STUDENT ACSC	STUDENT MCSC
STUDENT CGSC	STUDENT NPS
STUDENT NIU	
STUDENT (SDE Program)	
STUDENT AIR WAR COLLEGE	STUDENT EISENHOWER
FELLOW (Program)	
FELLOW LEGISLATIVE LIAISON	FELLOW AIR UNIVERSITY

2.2. For more information, see AFI 36-2406, "Officer and Enlisted Evaluations Systems" on the AF E-Publishing site, then click the "Publications + Forms" tab to search.

3. **Officer Promotion System.** AFI 36-2501, "Officer Promotions and Selective Continuation" contains information on officer promotion as well as selective continuation. Also included is detailed information on promotion opportunities, board timing, selection criteria, and selection boards. The most current information such as promotion board schedules, eligibility, and milestones can be found on MyFSS, Officer Promotions Home Page.

3.1. For more information, see AFI 36-2501 on the AF E-Publishing site, then click the "Publications + Forms" tab to search.

4. **Awards.** Supervisors should properly recognize and reward subordinates for exceptional performance. DAFMAN 36-2806, "Military Awards: Criteria and Procedures" contains the latest information on the Air Force Awards Program and can be accessed via the AF E-Publishing site. Additional trophy and award info can be found on the MyFSS Special Trophies and Awards site.

4.1. The Maintenance and Logistics Awards Program. Annual program designed to recognize and reward outstanding performance in several different categories specific to the Maintenance and Logistics enterprise. Groups and wings will pass specific guidance on each award.

4.2. Squadron/Wing/Direct Reporting Unit Recognition Programs. Local recognition programs vary by location and are often governed by either Operating Instructions, Supplements or Business Rules. Contact your unit's section commander or commander's support staff for a full listing of recognition programs available.

Section E – Acronym List

A&P – Airframe and Powerplant
AAD – Advanced Academic Degree
AAMOC – Accelerated Aircraft Maintenance Officer Course
ACA – Airman Comprehensive Assessment
AFCFM – Air Force Career Field Manger
AFCOMAC – Air Force Combat Ammunition Center
AFI – Air Force Instruction
AFIT – Air Force Institute of Technology
AFLOS – Air Force Logistics Officer School
AFMAN – Air Force Manual
DAFOCD – Department of the Air Force Officer Classification Directory
AFRC – Air Force Reserve Command
AFSC – Air Force Specialty Code
ALEET – Acquisition and Logistics Experience Exchange Tour
AMMOS – Advanced Maintenance and Munitions Operations School
AMOC – Aircraft Maintenance Officer Course
ARC – Air Reserve Component
ASPC – Advanced Sortie Production Course
BDE – Basic Developmental Education
BLBP – Base Level Broadening Program
CC – Commander
CDB – Career Development Brief
CFETP – Career Field Education and Training Plan
CFM – Career Field Manager
DAFI – Department of the Air Force Instruction
DAU – Defense Acquisition University
DE – Developmental Education
DLA – Defense Logistics Agency
DT – Development Team
EWI – Education with Industry
HAF – Headquarters Air Force
IDE – Intermediate Developmental Education
LCBP – Logistics Career Broadening Program
LCL – Life Cycle Logistics Certification
LOOP – Logistics Officer Orientation Program
MAJCOM – Major Command
MOIC – Maintenance Officer Intermediate Course
MXG – Maintenance Group
NAF – Numbered Air Force
NGB – National Guard Bureau
OCD – Officer Classification Directory

OCM – Occupational Competency Model
OES – Officer Evaluation System
OPB – Officer Performance Brief
OPD – Officer Professional Development
PDE – Primary Developmental Education
PME – Professional Military Education
PMP – Program Management Professional Certification
PMxCP – Air Force Professional Maintenance Certification Program
PRF – Promotion Recommendation Form
SDE – Senior Developmental Education
SQ – Squadron
TBA – Training Business Area
TTP – Tactics, Techniques, and Procedures
USAFA – United States Air Force Academy